range of workers' rights. The walk attracted policymakers and the ruling elite who could be drawn into conversation, and served as a committee room in motion.

As he left Rajasthan, Rahul Gandhi addressed a big public meeting and announced his support for a gig workers' social security legislation. A commitment from the Rajasthan Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot followed almost immediately. The framework went through many iterations and discussions, but resulted in what is perhaps the first gig workers' welfare legislation globally! It is significant that the law was drafted much along the lines of the consensus that emerged during the Yatra's consultations.

Structurally Analysing the Bharat Jodo Yatra

Social movements have struggled for decades to find recognition of their ideas as viable policy or legislative formulations. The Yatra's quick influence on policy must be recognized and understood. The framing of a policy or legislation with people involves a long and tedious process of agitation and advocacy before politicians and policymakers with others from the ruling elite get ready to listen and understand. It is generally the powerful voice of technocrats that is heard and reheard among those who make policy with ease, because of solidarities within their class. There has to be a strong commitment in the ruling elite to listen to and act on behalf of workers before their solutions can be heard and taken into consideration, over the din and warnings of dire consequences by those who have a vested interest in the working relationships that exist. Even in an open democracy, the imbalance of economic and social power makes progressive change very difficult.

The Yatra seemed to provide a well-designed and new platform to have the formulations and suggestions from people and their movements get heard in a more sensitive and effective way. Perhaps this was also because the 'walk' (padyatra) allowed people to be heard at a pace and in a mode that gave them confidence and strength.